Jiyoung Kim

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Placement Directors

Prof. Rui Castro	rui.castro@mcgill.ca	(514) 398-1226
Prof. Kensuke Sakamoto	kensuke.sakamoto@mcgill.ca	(438) 226-3871

Education

Ph.D. Economics — **McGill University**
Fall 2021–June 2027 (expected)

M.A. Economics — **Yonsei University**
Mar 2019–Feb 2021

B.A. Quantitative Risk Management and Economics — **Yonsei University**
Mar 2014–Aug 2018

Fields of Specialization

Primary: Macroeconomics
Secondary: Labor Economics

Dissertation

Firm-level Workforce Composition and Firm Dynamics
Supervisors: Prof. Rui Castro, Prof. Markus Poschke

Job Market Paper

"**Firm-level Workforce Composition and Firm Dynamics**"

Abstract.

This paper studies how a firm's choice of workforce quality differs by firm performance and how it evolves over a firm's life-cycle and then traces the implications for firm and aggregate productivity. Using Canadian matched employer–employee data, I measure a firm's workforce quality as the average worker-specific wage component, AKM worker fixed effects, of its employees, and take a firm's total years of operation as an indicator for firm performance. I uncover two facts: first, conditional on age, longer-lived firms have better workers; second, conditional on longevity, workforce quality declines as firms age. Firms therefore tend to start with a small, high-quality workforce and grow by expanding into lower-quality workers, with better firms hiring better workers. To explain these findings, I develop a firm dynamics model in which firms differ by productivity type. Conditional on the type, firms may improve firm-level productivity, by accumulating organizational capital with high-quality workers. The model is calibrated to match the observed patterns of workforce quality and firm performance. I then use it to quantify the consequences for Canadian firms and aggregate productivity of an increase in the cost of hiring high-quality workers. I find that a 1% increase in the wages of high-quality workers lowers long-run aggregate productivity by 0.6%. In Canada, the wage of top 1% workers compared to median workers has increased by approximately 10% in the last two decades, implying 6% loss in aggregate productivity if it remains so. Young firms are hit the hardest: the shock deprives them of the opportunity to accumulate organizational capital, which compounds into permanent losses in firm-level productivity. Reduced accumulation of organizational capital accounts for 80% of the long-run aggregate productivity loss.

Other Research Papers

- "**Predicting Labor Force Types**", NBER Working Paper (June, 2026) with Castro, Lange, Larivière and Poschke.
- "**Late Baby-Boomers and Early Millennials In and Out of Work**", in preparation for the *Canadian Journal of Economics* as part of the 2026 Innis Lecture with Castro, Lange, and Poschke

Teaching Experience

- Teaching Assistant, Econ 354: Macroeconomics — Honours 2, McGill University — 2026 W
- Teaching Assistant, Econ 450: Advanced Economic Theory 1, McGill University — 2023, 2024, 2025, 2026 W; 2026 F
- Teaching Assistant, Econ 713: Macroeconomic Theory 2 (Ph.D), McGill University — 2025 W
- Teaching Assistant, Econ 209: Macroeconomic Analysis & Applications, McGill University — 2025 Summer, 2025 F
- Teaching Assistant, Econ 332: Macroeconomic Theory — Majors 1, McGill University — 2024 F
- Teaching Assistant, Econ 208: Microeconomic Analysis & Applications, McGill University — 2022 F

Research and Relevant Work Experience

Research Assistant — **Korea Development Institute (KDI)**

Knowledge Sharing Program (KSP) — *Aug 2014–Apr 2016*

- Policy consultation for the Government of Belize on a national science, technology and innovation strategy
- Project report

Conference and Seminar Presentations

2026 CIREQ Lunch Seminar, McGill University, Aug
T2M Student Workshop Program, HEC Montreal, June
Canadian Economics Association, Simon Fraser University, May
20th CIREQ–CIRANO PhD Students' Conference, CIRANO Montreal, May
19th QICSS Emerging Excellence Conference, INRS, Apr
2025 CIREQ Lunch Seminar, McGill University, Nov
2024 Canadian Economics Association, Toronto Metropolitan University, May

Rewards and Grants

2021–2026 Graduate Excellence Award, McGill University
2026 Best Presentation Award, 19th QICSS Emerging Excellence Conference, INRS
2017 High Honors, Yonsei University

Languages

Korean (native), English (fluent), Spanish (advanced)

Computational Skills

Python, MATLAB, Stata, TensorFlow, Keras

References

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Prof. Markus Poschke	McGill University	markus.poschke@mcgill.ca	(514) 398-1233
Prof. Fabian Lange	McGill University	fabain.lange@mcgill.ca	(514) 653-0020